

# NOVATE Innovation Program Office Playbook & Training Guide - Customer Engagement

*Aligned to the NIN Engagement Lifecycle + IPO Dashboard Tiles*

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## Purpose

The Innovation Program Office (IPO) operates as NOVATE's performance-driven innovation lab, modeled after venture capital accelerators. This function tracks business outcomes, monetization opportunities, and measurable ROI from innovation challenges. It allows partners like the NFL to:

- Fund or co-develop POCs with clear business or sponsorship pathways
- Drive iterative prototyping and impact analysis
- Surface storytelling assets and commercialization opportunities

This guide equips IPO and PMO teams with a standardized method for identifying high-value innovation problems, validating program fit, and launching time-bound, outcome-driven pilots.

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## IPO Engagement Lifecycle (NIN-Aligned)

### 1. Forensic Discovery

- **Goal:** Understand the full context of the innovation challenge
- **Inputs:** System scans, org interviews, business pain statements
- **Tools:** NIN Forensics Intake, Stakeholder Map, Constraint Tracker
- **Outputs:** Executive Brief, System Inventory, Innovation Thesis

### 2. Diagnose Constraints & Opportunity Zones

- **Goal:** Surface systemic blockers, outcome potential, compliance, or tech dependencies
- **Tools:** Readiness Rubric, Risk Matrix, Ecosystem Map

- **Outputs:** Investment Posture, Risk Profile, Monetization Potential Map

### 3. Targeted POC Design

- **Decision Point:** Existing model fit (e.g., CivicGrid / Evergame) or new design?
- **Inputs:** Business Value Targets, Compliance + Sponsorship Factors, Outcome Logic
- **Outputs:** POC Design Canvas, ROI Framework, Demo Simulation Plan

### 4. Sign-Off & Launch Prep

- **Milestone:** Budget approval, sign-off from internal stakeholders or sponsors
- **Tools:** Sentrais POC Proposal Tile, Sponsorship Tracker, KPI Targets Deck
- **Outputs:** Finalized Implementation Plan, Funding Source, Assigned Delivery Pod

### 5. Execution + Reporting

- **Focus:** Track performance velocity, iteration loops, cross-functional accountability
- **Tools:** Sentrais Execution Tracker, KPI Board, Sponsor Updates + Demo Logs
- **Outputs:** Weekly Readouts, Iteration Scorecard, Performance Outcome Summary

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## Training Objectives

- Understand IPO as a business value accelerator, not just an R&D center
  - Align POCs with stakeholder goals, compliance risk, and monetization logic
  - Operate Sentrais Tiles to manage iteration speed and performance validation
  - Drive co-creation between PMO, BD, Sponsorship, and Tech functions.
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This playbook outlines the process for scoping, prototyping, and validating innovation under NOVATE's IPO model. It ensures that innovation isn't just exploratory, but also operational, fundable, and outcome-aligned.